

JULIAN TSANG

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, USA · *Non-degree graduate coursework* Mar 2026 – Jun 2026

- Real Analysis I: A (77/80 on the final exam, the highest score in the class)

University of Oxford, UK · *MPhil in Economics* Sep 2023 – Jun 2025

- Graduated with *Distinction* (US GPA equivalent: 4.0/4.0)
- Relevant courses: Core Microeconomics (82/100), Core Econometrics (73/100), Core Macroeconomics (70/100), and Advanced Econometrics (73/100); the Distinction threshold is 70/100
- Thesis: “Patronage or Purge? The Economic Impact of Elite Connections in China’s Leadership Transition” (supervised by Prof. Noam Yuchtman)

University College London, UK · *BSc Economics* Sep 2020 – Jun 2023

- Graduated with *First Class Honours* (average of 76/100 across three years; US GPA equivalent: 4.0/4.0)

GRE · Quantitative 170, Verbal 165, Analytical Writing 5.5 (top 3% of test takers)

RESEARCH

“Process Efficiency as a Barrier to Innovation” · *Working paper* 2026

- Builds a Klette–Kortum model in which firms split R&D between product innovation and process efficiency; because process improvements apply to every product line, large firms invest more in them, and R&D subsidies to large firms crowd out innovation by smaller firms
- In the 2008–2020 Chinese Tax Survey, a 10-percentage-point rise in large firms’ subsidy share lowers small-firm patenting by about 7%; in the calibrated model, reallocating subsidies across firm sizes raises welfare by 10.7%

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Professional, Becker Friedman Institute · *University of Chicago* Jul 2025 – Present

- Simulate and calibrate a dynamic model of firm innovation in which firms grow by improving the products they already make (scale) or by adding new ones (scope), matching the employment and product-variety shares of the largest firms in the economy (with Esteban Rossi-Hansberg and Chang-Tai Hsieh)
- Extended the spatial integrated assessment model of Cruz and Rossi-Hansberg (2024) to include a collapse of the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation on a $1^\circ \times 1^\circ$ global grid; found that the collapse lowers welfare on net but reverses the welfare losses for the regions hardest hit by climate change (with Esteban Rossi-Hansberg and Klaus Desmet)
- Extended the dynamic spatial model of Desmet et al. (2025) to endogenize the cost of human capital accumulation; used the model to predict income convergence across space over the very long run
- Led the revise-and-resubmit of “Local GDP Estimates Around the World” (Rossi-Hansberg and Zhang, 2026), accepted at the *Journal of Urban Economics*; designed uncertainty measures for the local GDP estimates and a variable-importance method to decompose the factors contributing to GDP divergence across grid cells

Research Assistant to Prof. Shaoda Wang · *University of Chicago* Oct 2024 – Jun 2025

- Constructed a measure of entrepreneur sentiment from 200,000 Weibo posts, used topic models (LDA) to document trends over time and across regions, and linked sentiment to government arrests of entrepreneurs
- Placed social media influencers on a left-right spectrum with LLM classification prompts (DeepSeek and OpenAI APIs) to track entrepreneurs’ political attitudes through forwarding patterns; used LASSO to identify the macroeconomic and firm-level drivers of sentiment

Research Assistant to Prof. David Yang · *Harvard University* Apr 2024 – Feb 2025

- Collected policy documents for 900 Chinese government-guided investment funds; wrote Python code using LLMs to extract variables on the funds’ geographical and sectoral investment requirements
- Extracted variables on industrial policy focus from national and provincial five-year plans and from annual reports of prefectural governments, 2001 to 2021, using regular expressions, text mining, and LLMs

Research Assistant to Dr. Andrea Bernini · *University of Oxford* Jan 2024 – Sep 2024

- Helped address referees’ comments in the revise-and-resubmit of a paper on NAFTA’s effect on income inequality in Mexico, including concerns about the identification strategy and its limitations

- Wrote the section of a paper on the 1990 German reunification and East German gender differences in smoking that quantifies the implications for public health expenditure and the gender mortality gap

OTHER EXPERIENCE

RBB Economics (economic consultancy), London, UK · *Intern* Jun 2024 – Sep 2024

- Worked on a UK steel merger; cleaned sales data to show the closeness of competition between the merging parties in response to information requests from the Competition and Markets Authority

Capital Pilot (venture capital firm), London, UK · *Consultant* Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

- Evaluated early-stage startups and developed metrics adopted in the firm's investment rating system

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

UCL Mahjong Society, London, UK · *President* Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

- Organized weekly sessions that introduced East Asian games to members, and taught the games to beginners
- Led a London inter-university contest with LSE, King's College London, and Imperial College London

AWARDS AND HONORS

- Distinction, MPhil in Economics (University of Oxford, 2025)
- First Class Honours, BSc Economics (University College London, 2023)
- Finalist, UCL Explore Econ research competition (2022 and 2023)
- A* in all four International A-Levels (2020; Highest Mark in the World for Economics, 2019)

MISCELLANEOUS

- **Programming:** MATLAB, Python, Julia, R, Stata, Dynare, and $\text{\LaTeX}$
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Cantonese (native), and Mandarin
- **Interests:** Tennis, Climbing, Volunteering, and Traveling to Ethnic Minority Areas in China

REFERENCES

Prof. Esteban Rossi-Hansberg

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Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
University of Chicago
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Prof. Juanma Castro-Vincenzi

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Prof. Chang-Tai Hsieh

Phyllis and Irwin Winkelried Distinguished Service Professor of Economics
Booth School of Business
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Prof. Klaus Desmet

Ruth and Kenneth Altshuler Centennial Interdisciplinary Professor of Economics
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